

JOHN GLENN

Born 1921

In 1998, at the age of 77, Glenn flew on a space shuttle to become the **oldest-ever astronaut**.

DATA FILE



KEY ACHIEVEMENT: First American to orbit Earth



COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: United States



YEAR OF ACHIEVEMENT: 1962

John Glenn made three orbits of our planet in 1962 to become the first American to orbit Earth. As he passed over Australia in the dark, the residents of Perth switched on all their lights to greet him. Glenn's capsule, Friendship 7, splashed down safely in the Atlantic Ocean and he was picked up by a navy ship.